Visual Studio LIVE! | Las Vegas
EXPERT SOLUTIONS FOR ENTERPRISE DEVELOPERS

Agile-ish: Lightweight Project Management with GitHub Projects

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Raise Your Hand If...

...you're doing Scrum

...you're doing Kanban

...you invented something and aren't sure what to call it

...you're doing Scrum but skip half the ceremonies

Nobody Can See What's Happening.

Type of automated test

Goal:

- Verify the behavior of an application…
- …without requiring human involvement

Did Working Software Get Out the Door?

Type of automated test

Goal:

- Verify the behavior of an application…
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Where Does Your Code Live?

Your code is in GitHub

Your PRs and CI/CD are in GitHub

Your project management is in... Jira? A spreadsheet? Someone's head?

Context-switching kills more projects than bad methodology

GitHub Projects in 30 Seconds

Flexible views: table, board, roadmap

Custom fields, views, and workflows

Not too simple, not too prescriptive

What We're Building Today

From zero to a working project workflow — live

Then: delivery intelligence on top of it

Everything you need to start tonight

Forget the Framework. Answer Three Questions.

Question 1

What are we going to work on?

Question 2

What are we working on right now?

Question 3

Are we on track?

The Ceremony Trap

Story points → hours of debate, estimates are still wrong

Rigid sprint boundaries → artificial pressure, work carries over

Required meetings → people zone out in the ones that don't apply

Still Behind
Schedule.

What Agile-ish Actually Looks Like

Always Do This

Prioritized list of work

Break work into small chunks

Track what's in progress

Maybe, Maybe Not

Fixed-length sprints

Story point estimation

Daily standup

The Mental Model: Repos, Issues, and Projects

Repos

Issues

Pull Requests

Projects

Draft Issues vs. Real Issues

Draft Issues

Quick capture — napkin ideas

Live only in the Project

No issue number, no repo link

Real Issues

Linked to a repo — full capabilities

Can be referenced in PRs and commits

Promote drafts when you're serious

Demo: GitHub Projects from Scratch

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Stop Estimating.
Start Measuring.

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Two Numbers That Tell You Almost Everything

Throughput: how many things you finish per week

Cycle Time: how long things take from start to finish

That's it. No story points. No velocity. Just count and measure.

What If You Already Had the Data?

Predicting the Future with Monte Carlo

Monte Carlo simulation: 1,000 versions of your next few weeks

"We're 85% confident this will be done by March 28."

I wrote a free tool that does this. Let me show you.

Demo: Honest Cheetah — Delivery Intelligence

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What We Built Today

Prioritized backlog with custom fields and real-world statuses

Iteration planning, task breakdown, and day-to-day tracking

Sprint charts AND delivery forecasting

All free tools. Set it up tonight.

Save It as a Template

Save your configured project as an org template

New projects get your views, fields, and workflows out of the box

Automations Worth Enabling

Item added → set Status to "Todo"

PR linked to issue → set Status to "In Progress"

Item closed → set Status to "Done"

What GitHub Projects Doesn't Do (Yet)

No native dependencies or blocking relationships

Limited charting — functional, not sophisticated

No capacity planning

Basic automation — complex workflows need Actions

The Agile-ish Checklist

What's most important right now?

What's everyone working on?

Is anything stuck or aging?

When will it probably be done?

Go Build It Tonight.

Resources

Honest Cheetah: honestcheetah.com — free for GitHub & Azure DevOps

Flow Metrics & GitHub Projects video series on YouTube

Blog & consulting: benday.com | @benday